BUSINESS AI STACK · CHAPTER 28

Vercel and AWS

A practical guide with steps, examples and a checklist. Read the chapter, then build the example.

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Deployment with Vercel and AWS

Deployment means putting your app on a server so customers can use it. Vercel is the simplest option for Next.js apps. AWS gives you full control for systems that need it.

Which to choose

Need	Vercel	AWS
Next.js website or dashboard	Easiest: connect GitHub, every push deploys	Possible, more setup (for example Amplify or containers)
Background jobs, custom servers, private networks	Limited	Strong: EC2, Lambda, ECS, RDS and more
Who should run it	A small team with no DevOps	A team that owns its infrastructure

Deploy a Next.js app to Vercel

1. Push your project to a GitHub repository. Keep `.env.local` out of Git (check `.gitignore`).
2. In Vercel, choose "Add new project", pick the repository and accept the detected Next.js settings.
3. Add the environment variables (Supabase URL, publishable key, any API keys) in the project settings for Production and Preview.
4. Deploy. Each push to the main branch creates a new production build; each branch gets a preview link.

When you move to AWS

- Use separate accounts or roles for development and production.
- Store secrets in AWS Secrets Manager or Parameter Store, never in code.
- Turn on billing alerts before you launch.
- Use the least-privilege principle: each service gets only the permissions it needs.

SECURITY BASICS FOR ANY HOST

Use HTTPS only. Keep keys in environment variables. Rotate any key that was ever pasted into chat or a public repository. Limit who can change production settings.

Checklist

- Production URL loads over HTTPS.
- Environment variables are set for production.
- A rollback plan: you can redeploy the previous version in one click (Vercel) or from the last tag (AWS).

Reference: Vercel documentation for Next.js deployments and the AWS documentation for the services you choose. Pricing depends on usage; check the current pricing pages.